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Superseding
MIL-C-14633A
31 March 1972

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CASES, DECORATION, PRESENTATION

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope.--This specification covers presentation cases for decorations awarded within the Department of Defense.

1.2 Classification.--Cases covered by this specification shall be of the following types and classes (see 6.4).

Type I--Medal of Honor
  Class 1--US Military Personnel
  Class 1A--US Military Personnel (with extra tabs)

Type II--Distinguished Service Cross
  Class 1--US Army Personnel
  Class 1A--US Army Personnel (with extra tabs)
  Class 2--Civilian & Foreign Military Personnel
  Class 2A--Civilian & Foreign Military Personnel (with extra tabs)

Type III--Navy Cross
  Class 1--Navy and Marine Corps Personnel
  Class 1A--Navy and Marine Corps Personnel (with extra tabs)

Type IV--Air Force Cross
  Class 1--Air Force Personnel
  Class 1A--Air Force Personnel (with extra tabs)
  Class 2--Civilian & Foreign Military Personnel
  Class 2A--Civilian Foreign Military Personnel (with extra tabs)

Type V--Distinguished Service Medal
  Class 2--US Military, Civilian & Foreign Military Personnel
  Class 2A--US Military, Civilian & Foreign Military Personnel
    (with extra tabs)

Type VI--Legion of Merit, Chief Commander
  Class 1--Regular
  Class 1A--With extra tabs

Type VII--Legion of Merit, Commander
  Class 1--Regular
  Class 1A--With extra tabs

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: Director, The Institute of Heraldry, US Army, Cameron Station, Alexandria, VA 22314, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

/FSC 8455/

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Type VIII--All Military department decorations not listed.
Class 1--US Military Personnel
Class 1A--US Military Personnel (with extra tabs)
Class 2--Civilian & Foreign Military Personnel
Class 2A--Civilian & Foreign Military Personnel (with extra tabs)

Type IX--The Presidential Citizens Medal
Class 2--All Personnel

Type X--Defense Distinguished Service Medal
Class 2--All Personnel

Type XI--Congressional Space Medal of Honor
Class 2--All Personnel

Type XII--National Intelligence Distinguished Service Medal
Class 2--All Personnel

Type XIII--National Intelligence Medal for Achievement
Class 2--All Personnel

Type XIV--Defense Superior Service Medal
Class 2--All Personnel

Type XV--All Civilian Agency Decorations not listed
Class 2--All Personnel

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS
FEDERAL
QQ-A-250/5-Aluminim Alloy Alclad 2024, Plate and Sheet
PPP-B-636--Box, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-676--Boxes, Set-Up

STANDARDS
FEDERAL
FED-STD-191--Textile; Test Methods
MILITARY
MIL-STD-105--Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129--Marking for Shipment and Storage

DRAWINGS
THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY
4-4-85--Cases, Decoration, Presentation, Assembly and Details
4-4-85A--Pads for Cases, Decoration, Presentation, Class 1 and Class 2
4-4-93--Pads for Cases, Decoration, Presentation, Class 1A and Class 2A

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(Copies of specifications, standards and drawings required by the contractor in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

(Figures 1, 2 and 3 are miniature reproductions of the referenced drawings and are attached for information only.)

2.2 Other publications.--The following document forms a part of this specification to the exten specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

United States Army Color Card, The Official Colors for Branches, Agencies, Etc.

(Application for copies of the aforementioned document should be addressed to The Color Association of the United States, Inc., 24 East 38th Street, New York, NY 10016.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard sample.

3.1.1 Case, covering.--Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2) the contracting officer shall furnish a standard sample of the case covering for matching color and finish of the cover only.

3.1.2 Plushes or flocking and satin cloth.--The contracting officer will furnish a sample of gray and white plush or flocking and a sample of the satin cloth for color, texture and quality.

3.2 First article sample.--Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, the first article sample shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for examinations and inspection as specified in 4.2. The approval of the first article authorizes the commencement of production but does not relieve the contractor from compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The first article shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.3 Materials.--Materials shall conform to the referenced specifications and the requirements specified herein.

3.3.1 Steel.--Steel for the case shell and attachment tabs shall be any commercial grade of sheet steel suitable for this purpose.

3.3.2 Cord, elastic.--When elastic cord is required for the case, the cord shall be any type commercial grade, woven elastic cord, 1/16 inch in diameter and vat dyed yellow Cable No. 65002.

3.3.3 Paper.--Paper for lining the back of the pads and the interior top and

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bottom of the case shall be 120 pound white chipboard, finish No. 4, 1/32 inch in thickness.

3.3.4 Hinge.--The hinge for the case shall be a piano type brass plated steel hinge 2-7/8 inches, plus or minus 1/8 inch in length. The overall width of the hinge shall be 5/8 inch, plus or minus 1/64 inch. The thickness of the leaf shall be a minimum of 1/64 inch. The hinge shall be fitted with two spring steel clips insuring closure of the case unless an upward force is exerted on the lid.

3.3.5 Gold for plating.--Gold for plating shall be 24 Karat.
3.3.6 Wire for loop attachments.--The wire for the loop attachments shall be any type gold plated brass wire, .031 inch, plus or minus .005 inch in diameter. The exposed length of the loop shall be 1/2 inch, plus or minus 1/8 inch.

3.3.7 Cover.--At the option of the manufacturer the cover of the case may be fabricated from either a pyroxylin coated cloth or morocco grain vinyl.

3.3.7.1 Pyroxylin coated cloth.--The base cloth for the pyroxylin coated cloth shall be dyed dark blue to approximate the shade of the pyroxylin coating. The sheeting shall weigh 2.5 ounces per square yard and the sheeting construction shall have a minimum of 56 ends and 56 picks. The coated side of the cloth will match the standard sample in color and finish.

3.3.7.2 Vinyl.--When vinyl is used for the cover, the vinyl shall be a .010 inch thick navy blue morocco grain material having a minus 10 degrees F. cold crack resistance and good grain retention characteristic at processing temperature (see 6.3).

3.3.8 Lacquer.--The lacquer shall be a pale, clear, synthetic lacquer. The use of pigmented lacquer shall not be permitted.

3.3.9 Mylar leaf.--The leaf pattern and lettering shall be accomplished with imitation gold mylar leaf.

3.3.10 Aluminum. The aluminum for the tabs shall conform to QQ-A-250/5, condition O.

3.4 Construction.--Cases shall be constructed in accordance with drawing 4-4-85. All dimensions given are finished dimensions. The cases shall consist of a lid section and a lower section made from .015, plus or minus .002 inch thick steel specified in 3.3.1 and joined by a hinge specified in 3.3.4. A polyurethane pad 3/32 inch thick shall be glued to the exterior top of the lid shell. The exterior surfaces and interior walls of both sections shall be coupled with pyroxylin coated cotton sheeting specified in 3.3.7.1 or vinyl 6 specified in 3.3.7.2. Except for the portion of the edges covered by the hinge, both sections of the case shall have a brass striking edge. The edge may be made from any type brass or brass plated steel, and shall have a mirror-like polished, finish and shall be coated with lacquer specified in 3.3.8 prior to assembly. The edge shall be formed from brass .008 inch, plus or minus .002

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inch in thickness. The ends of the striking edge shall be butted within 1/4 inch of the ends of the hinge.

3.4.1 Lid section.--The top outside surface of the lid shall contain the leaf pattern, the words, "United States of America" and, when applicable, the decoration title as shown on drawing 4-4-85. The lettering and design shall be imprinted using mylar leaf specified in 3.3.9. Letters (types and sizes) and placement of the lettering and pattern shall be in the style shown on drawing 4-4-85 and as specified herein. The interior of the lid section shall have a satin cloth covered die-cut cardboard form securely glued to the metal shell. The die-cut form shall be 7-3/16 inches in length by 4-1/2 inches in width with the reverse side line cut 6-3/8 inches in width and the corners notched approximately 45 degrees from 1/2 inch borders or walls. The face and walls of the form shall be covered with sufficient satin cloth to create a pillowy effect when the walls are positioned at a 45 degree angle and the form glued to the lid of the case.

3.4.1.1 Lettering.--The words "United States of America" shall appear on all style cases and all letters shall be accomplished using upper case, Copper Plate, 10 Point Gothic.

3.4.1.1.1 Styles 1 and 6.--No additional lettering required.

3.4.1.1.2 Styles 2, 3, and 7.--Lettering for styles 2, 3 and 7 cases shall be accomplished using Bodoni Componile type face, 36 point caps for the first letter in each word and 24 point caps for all other letters.

3.4.1.1.3 Styles 4, 5, and 8.--Lettering for styles 4, 5, and 8 cases shall be accomplished using Wiess Roman Bold type face, 30 point caps for the first letter in each word and 18 point caps for all other letters except the word "Chief Commander" and "Commander" on the type VI and VII cases shall be accomplished using upper case, Copper Plate, 14 Point Gothic.

3.4.1.2 Leaf pattern.--The leaf pattern shall be as shown on drawing 4-4-85.

3.4.2 Lower section.--Except for the hinge, the interior walls of the lower section shall be covered with a dust shield. The dust shield shall be an integral part of the molded bottom and shall be glued to the bottom as shown on drawing 4-4-85. The insert shall be molded from .015 inch thick impact quality styrene with a cotton flock face. The flocking shall be white to match the white plush. The contractor shall mold his name or trademark in the lower third of the insert. The letters shall not exceed 3/8 inch in height. At the hinged end of the case the free ends of the dust shield and the hinge shall be covered with satin cloth. The satin cloth shall have the sides neatly pinked or fused to prevent raveling.

3.4.3 Pads.

3.4.3.1 Class 1 and class 2 pads.--The class 1 and class 2 pads shall be fabricated from 14-ply bristol board and shall conform to the details and

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dimensions shown on drawing 4-4-85A. The face, edges and minimum of 3/8 inch on all sides of the back of the pad shall be covered with gray plush or flocking. After the applicable attachments have been securely anchored, the reverse side of the pad shall be covered with paper specified in 3.3.3. The tab attachments shall be fabricated from steel specified in 3.3.1. The steel shall be .015 inch plus or minus .002 inch thick. The lift tabs shall be made from white satin ribbon 3/8 inch wide, doubled over with a selvage along each edge.

3.4.3.2 Class 1A and class 2A pads.--The class 1A and class 2A pads shall be fabricated from 14-ply bristol board and shall conform to the details and dimensions shown on drawing 4-4-93. The face, edges and 3/8 inch on the reverse side of the pads shall be covered with gray plush or flocking. After the wire loops, tab attachments, lift tabs and and when applicable elastic cords have been securely anchored the reverse side of the pad shall be covered with paper specified in 3.3.3. The tab attachments, except for the lapel button tab, shall be fabricated from steel specified in 3.3.1. The lapel button tab shall be fabricated from aluminum specified in 3.3.10. The steel tabs shall be fabricated from .015 inch plus or minus .002 inch stock. The aluminum tabs shall be fabricated from .023 inch, plus or minus .002 inch stock. The lift tabs shall be made from white satin ribbon, 3/8 inch wide doubled over with a selvage along each edge.

3.5 Workmanship.--Cases shall be clean, well made, and shall meet the acceptable quality levels established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Inspection responsibility.--Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 First article inspection.--When a first article is required, examination shall be made on a completely finished case for all provisions of this specification applicable to end item examination.

4.3 Sampling for inspection and acceptance.--Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.3.1 Component and material inspection.--In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.3.1.1 Certification of compliance.--Components listed below may be accepted on the basis of a contractor's certification of compliance for the requirements specified in applicable paragraphs of this specification.

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Component	Characteristics	Rqm't para
Cord, elastic	Material identification, diameter and color	3.3.2
Paper	Material identification and weight, finish and thickness	3.3.3
Hinge	Material identification and plating	3.3.4
Attachment loop wire	Material identification and karat of plating	3.3.6
Pyroxylin coated cloth	Material identification, color, weight, and number of ends and picks	3.3.7.1
Vinyl material	Material identification, thickness, minus 10 degrees F cold crack resistance, grain retention	3.3.7.2
Lacquer	Material identification	3.3.8
Mylar leaf	Material identification	3.3.9
Polyurethane pad	Material identification and thickness	3.4
Striking edge	Material identification	3.4
Molded insert	Material identification, thickness and facing	3.4.2
Lift tab	Material identification	3.4.3
Pad	Material identification and plies	3.4.3
Tabs	Material identification and thickness	3.4.3

4.3.2 Process examination.--Examination shall be made during the manufacturing process for the requirements listed below to establish that no deviation is made from indicated requirements. Whenever a nonconformance is noted, correction shall be made to affected items and the process.

Requirements or Operation	Rqm't para
Polyurethane pad is glued to the exterior top of lid shell	3.4
Die-cut cardboard form securely glued to metal shell interior of the lid section	3.4.1
Wire loops, metal tab attachments, lift tabs and elastic cords securely anchored to reverse side of pad	3.4.3
Sides of back of pad are covered with a minimum of 3/8 inch of gray plush or flocking	3.4.3

4.3.3 Inspection of the end item.

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4.3.3.1 Visual examination of case.--Examination shall be made at a distance of 16 to 22 inches under normal daylight or its equivalent. The defects found during examination shall be classified in accordance with 4.3.3.1.1 and

4.3.3.1.2. The unit of product for these examinations shall be one completely sabricated case. The inspection level and the acceptable quality level (AQL's) shall be as specified in 4.3.3.1.3.

Examine	Defects	Classification Major	(*)	Minor
Exterior surface	Color and finish does not match the standard approved sample	x	-	-
	Not covered as specified	x	-	-
	Pattern or lettering missing	x	-	-
	Not correct pattern or lettering	-	*	-
	Lettering incorrect size or position	-	*	-
	Covering not taut, i.e., any wrinkle(s), bubble(s), or crease	x	-	-
	Visible imperfection in cover, i.e., spotted or stained, cut, torn, abraded or otherwise damaged	-	*	-
	Pattern or lettering not clear or not free of voids or skips	-	*	-
Interior surfaces	Plush, flocking or satin does not match the standard or approved sample for color, finish or texture	x	-	-
	Visible imperfection in plush, or flocking, elastic cord or satin, i.e., stained, disclored, cut, torn, frayed or otherwise damaged	-	*	-
	Elastic cord not correct color	-	-	x
	Satin cloth does not have picked or fushed sides	-	-	x
Workmanship	Hinge not as specified	x	-	-
	Lid (when closed) is not aligned with the bottom of the case	x	-	-
	Lid does not close completely over components	x	-	-
	Lid does not spring closed when released from a 30 degree angle	x	-	-
	Case is punctured, broken, indented, malformed or otherwise damaged	x	-	-

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Examine	Defects	Classification Major	(*)	Minor
	Metal edge contains sharp edge, burr or is dented, bent or otherwise damaged.....	-	*	-
	Hinge not covered on the inside with satin cloth.....	x	-	-
	Lid recess for dust shield not at 45 degree angle.....	-	-	x
	Attachment(s), lift tab(s), wire loop(s) or cord not securely anchored.....	-	*	-
	Ends of striking edge not butted flush with ends of the hinge.....	-	-	x
	Does not contain metal edge on lid and lower section of case.....	x	-	-
	Metal edge is not mirror-like polished or is not lacquered..	-	-	x
	The face and walls of the interior lid does not have a pillowy effect.....	-	*	-
	Incorrect pad or no pad.....	x	-	-
	Pad not covered as specified.....	-	*	-
	Molded insert missing.....	x	-	-
	Molded insert not securely glued to shell.....	-	*	-
	One or more die-cut areas missing from pad.....	x	-	-
	Die-cut area(s) not proper size or not in the proper location.....	-	*	-
Marking	Marking not placed as required.....	-	*	-
	Missing, illegible or incorrect.....	-	-	x

4.3.3.1.1 Examination for defects in finish, design, material, construction, workmanship and marking.--Defects designated by an asterisk (*) shall be classified as major when seriously affecting appearance or serviceability and minor when affecting appearance or serviceability but not seriously.

4.3.3.1.2 Examination of cases for defects in dimensions.--Any dimension that is not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect.

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4.3.3.1.3 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's).--The inspection levels and the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

	Inspection level	AQL Major	AQL Total
For defects applicable to 4.3.3.1.1	II	2.5	10.0
For defects applicable to 4.3.3.1.2	S-2	(one class)	2.5

4.3.3.1.4 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements.--An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements of section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, any component damaged, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of component such as incomplete closure of container flaps, inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted containers.
Weight	Weight exceeds requirements.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.--Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.--Two polyurethane pads 3 inches square by 1/4 inch thick and a one inch, in width, paperboard sleeve capable of fitting snugly over the closed case shall be placed within each case. The polyurethane pad may be any color providing the dyed pad is colorfast to dry or wet cracking when tested as specified in FED-STD-191. Each case so prepared shall be placed in a snug-fitting, set-up paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676. Box closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.1.2 Level C.--Cases shall be preserved and packaged to afford adequate protection against deterioration, corrosion and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier's commercial practice will be acceptable when it fulfills the above requirements.

5.2 Packing.--Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.--Cases of one type only packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to class weather resistant, type V3c or V3s of PPP-B-636. Closure and reinforcement shall be in accordance with the appendix of the applicable specification.

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5.2.2 Level B.-- Cases of one type only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to class Domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.3 Level C.--Cases, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with rules and regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.--In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), unit packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.--Cases covered by this specification are intended to be used as presentation cases for decorations awarded by the U.S. Government.

6.2 Ordering data.--Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.

(b) Type and class required (see 1.2).

(c) When standard samples will not be furnished (see 3.1).

(d) When a first article is not required (see 3.2).

(e) When special marking is required (see 3.5 and 5.3).

(f) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Color.--Tanotex quality 104, Morocco, Two/Tone Royal Blue #5960 is known to meet the color requirements.

6.4 The class 1A and the class 2A pads were developed to accept button back lapel buttons and service ribbons with a pin and catch type attaching device and should be specified only when components of this type are being supplied as Government furnished property. When components are being furnished by the contractor only class 1 or class 2 pads, as applicable, shall be specified.

Custodians:
Army--IH
Air Force--11
Navy--PE
Review Activities:
Navy--PE, MC
Air Force--99
User Activities:
Air Force--45
Navy--CG
DLA--CT
Project No. 8455 - 0943

Preparing Activity:

The Institute of Heraldry,
United States Army

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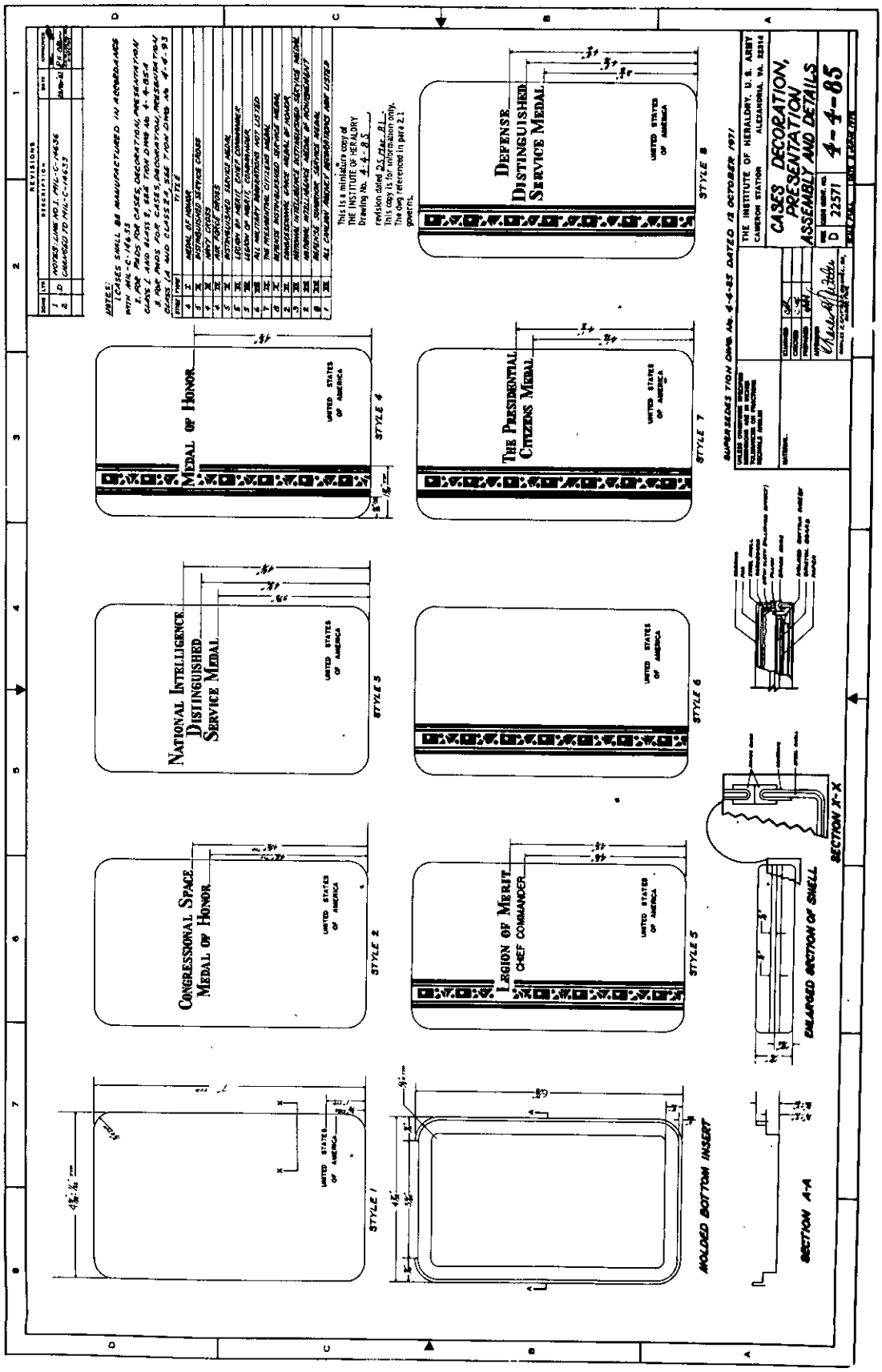


FIGURE 1

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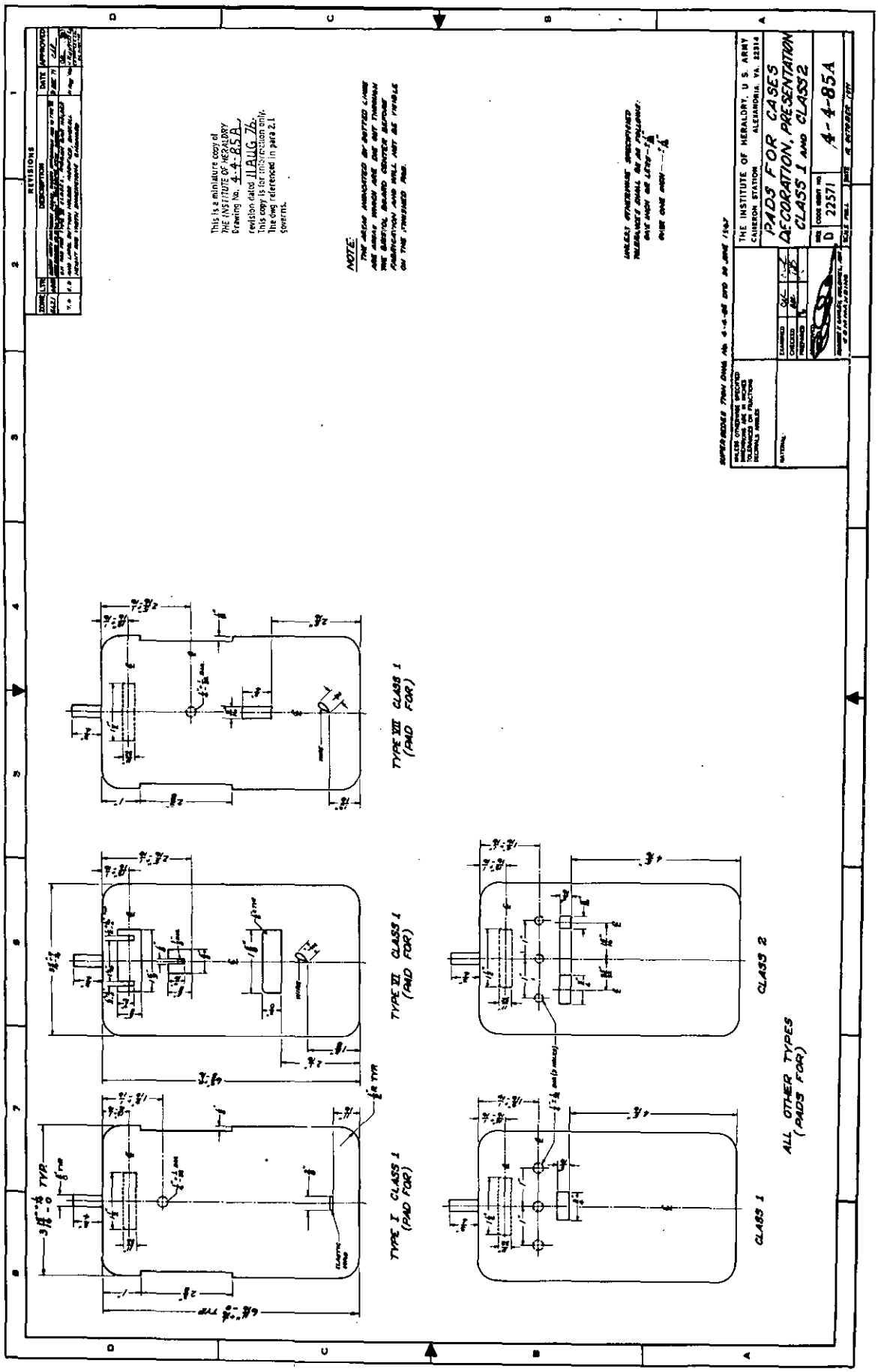


FIGURE 2

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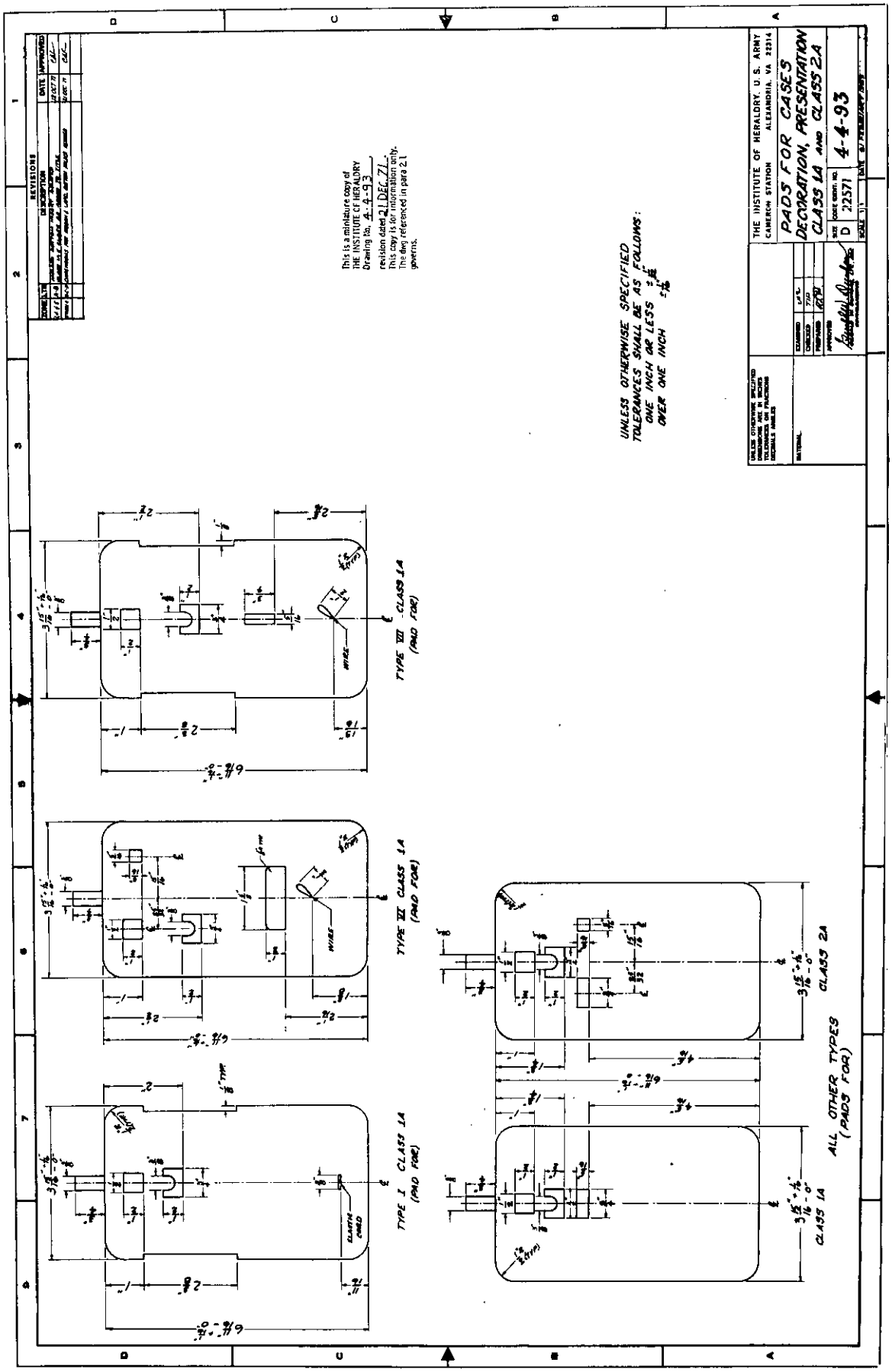


FIGURE 3

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